TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Catch Up With Someone You Haven't Seen for a Long Time

Narrate | PPF | Experience Sharing

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Catch up with someone you have not seen for years: tell two or three things that happened, what you do now and what is next, then ask about their news.

WHO	Three years ago you and Amy worked in the same office. Then she left to become a coach, and you have not seen each other since.
SITUATION	Saturday night, a wedding dinner at a Chinese restaurant in JB. Amy is at your table. Before the food comes, she says: “Long time no see! It’s been three years. So, what’s new?”
NEED	Amy wants the main news, not every detail: two or three things that happened, what you do now and what you are planning. She wants to tell you her news too.
GOAL	Tell your news in order (then → now → next), with two or three highlights, and ask her back, so it is a conversation, not a speech.

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Amy asks: “Hey! Long time no see! It’s been three years. So, what’s new with you?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Siti's answer. Mark where each part starts.

When we last met, four years ago, I was still working at the travel agency in town. Then in 2023, I joined a small company, and last year I got married! These days, I'm in HR there. We're only twelve people, so I know everyone, and so far I've really enjoyed it. Next year, we're going to buy our own place, probably a small condo in Tebrau, near my husband's parents. But enough about me! What about you? Are you still at the travel agency these days?

P THEN · SINCE WE LAST MET

_____

P NOW · THESE DAYS

_____

F NEXT · THE PLAN

_____

! ASK THEM BACK

_____

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Mei Ling meets an old neighbour at the mall after five years: then → now → next → ask back.

- ☐ Next year, I'm going to start a diploma in accounting. It takes two years.
- ☐ These days, I'm an accounts assistant in JB, and I check about 200 invoices a month.
- ☐ Anyway, that's me. What about you? Is your family still in Skudai these days?
- ☐ Five years ago, when we were neighbours in Skudai, I was still working at a hardware shop. After that, I took a night course.

Write the letter: **P** = Then · since we last met · **P** = Now · these days · **F** = Next · the plan · **!** = Ask them back

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

THEN · SINCE WE LAST MET

- [ ] When we last met, I was still …
- [ ] Then in (year), I …
- [ ] After that, I …
- [ ] Last year, I …

NOW

- [ ] These days, I'm …
- [ ] Right now, I …
- [ ] So far, it's been …

NEXT

- [ ] Next year, I'm going to …
- [ ] I'm planning to …
- [ ] I'm hoping to …

ASK THEM BACK · REACT

- [ ] Really? That's great!
- [ ] But enough about me.
- [ ] What about you?
- [ ] Are you still …?

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. I left the travel agency in 2023. [Or / For example, / Then] I joined a small company in town.

2. When we last met, I was single. [because / for example, / but] Now I'm married!

3. I'm studying at night. [for example, / or / because] I want a better job next year.

4. I finish the diploma next June. [So far, / For example, / After that,] I'm going to ask for a promotion.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. Then in 2023, I _____ a small company. (Something that happened, with a year)
   - ○ joining
   - ○ joined
   - ○ was join
2. When we last met, I _____ at a travel agency. (The background: your life when you last met)
   - ○ was work
   - ○ was working
   - ○ were working
3. These days, I _____ in HR. (Your life these days)
   - ○ work
   - ○ am work
   - ○ working
4. Next year, we _____ buy our own place. (A plan)
   - ○ are go to
   - ○ are going to
   - ○ going to

SLIDE 09 Setting the scene: was / were + -ing

To say what your life was like when you last met, use was / were + -ing (add still). For the things that happened after that, use the past simple with a time.

When we last met, I **was** still **working** at the travel agency.

Five years ago, we **were living** next door in Skudai.

Then in 2023, I **joined** a small company.

Are you **still working** there these days?

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

P

THEN · SINCE WE LAST MET

When we last met, I was still … Then in …, I …

P

NOW · THESE DAYS

These days, I'm …

F

NEXT · THE PLAN

Next year, I'm going to …

!

ASK THEM BACK

But enough about me! What about you?

SLIDE 11

Experience Sharing

Two old friends catch up. Each tells two or three things in order, now and next, then asks back: from a card first, then their own news. The listener cannot see the card and fills the catch-up note.

1. Quiet time (2:00): read your card. Choose two or three things that happened. Plan: then → now → next → ask back.
2. Round 1 (3:00 each), your card: tell, then ask back. Partner writes the note, reads it back: 'First you …, then …'.
3. Line B moves one seat. Round 2 (2:00 each): same card, new partner, shorter: only two things, now, next, ask back.
4. Line B moves. Round 3 (1:00 each), frames closed, workbook turned over: your own real news (or your card again).

Card 1 · Old colleague from the hotel

Card 2 · Old friend from badminton

Card 3 · Old colleague from the factory

Card 4 · Old classmate from secondary school

Catch-up note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Since then: when, what			
Now			
Next, and when?			
Asked me back? Yes / No			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Amy asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. **Oh, when did that happen?**
2. **And what is that like these days?**
3. **So when does that start?**

Start with: **It was about … ago. / In …, I … · It's good. These days, I … · Next …, I'm going to …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

Kumar is back in the office after four months at a customer's factory in Melaka. At lunch he asks you: 'So, what's new with you?' Tell him two things that happened at work, what you are doing now and what is next. Then ask about him. No news? Use these: two months ago, Ali changed all the office computers · last month, a new colleague joined your team · now: you are training her · next month: the annual dinner.

After you left, I … · These days, I'm … · Next month, I'm going to … · And what about you? How was Melaka?

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Tells two or three things that happened, in order, each with a time word.
- [ ] Says what they do now and what they plan next.
- [ ] Asks the other person back about their news.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Two or three things, in order	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Now and next	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Asking back	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · Old colleague from the hotel

An old colleague. Ask: 'So, what's new?' Write the note and read it back. A line is empty? Ask for it. Then ask: 'How is it going?' Answer 'What about you?' in one sentence.

Card 2 · Old friend from badminton

An old friend. Ask: 'So, what's new?' Write the note and read it back. A line is empty? Ask for it. Then ask about the plan: 'Which month?' Answer 'What about you?' in one sentence.

Card 3 · Old colleague from the factory

An old colleague. Ask: 'So, what's new?' Write the note and read it back. A line is empty? Ask for it. Then ask: 'When did that happen?' Answer 'What about you?' in one sentence.

Card 4 · Old classmate from secondary school

An old classmate. Ask: 'So, what's new?' Write the note and read it back. A line is empty? Ask for it. Then ask: 'What is a normal day like?' Answer 'What about you?' in one sentence.

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · Old colleague from the hotel

2024: my son was born · Now: the stall opens 6 days a week, 6 a.m. to 1 p.m. · Last met: 5 years ago, both on the front desk · Bought a new phone · In January: start selling online · 2023: opened a nasi lemak stall in Skudai

Card 2 · Old friend from badminton

Next year, in June: take the family to Japan · Last met: 4 years ago, in Kluang · Got a new car · Now: at an insurance company, working from home 3 days a week · 2022: moved to JB · 2025: finished a part-time degree

Card 3 · Old colleague from the factory

Joined a gym · 2021: moved to Singapore, 3 years in a warehouse · Now: office manager at a clinic in Kulai · Last met: 6 years ago, in Pasir Gudang · In December: getting married · 2024: came back to JB to look after my mother

Card 4 · Old classmate from secondary school

Now: driving a school van, 2 trips a day, 6.30 a.m. and 1 p.m. · Last met: 3 years ago, at a class reunion · Last year: moved to a condo in Permas Jaya · Next year: buy a second van · New hair colour · 2024: left a shipping office